

Product Designer Home Assignment

Hey 🙌

Welcome to your home assignment, it's awesome you made it this far with us!

The goal of this assignment is to give you a chance to show off your product design skills and thinking. It's your time to shine! ✨

This exercise should give you a good idea of the kind of work we do here at Akamai and will help us understand your approach to Product Design and your fit for the role.

Some Background:

At Akamai, we build advanced cybersecurity platforms that help organizations protect their employees, data, and internal systems from cyber threats.

Our primary user is **Daniel, a SOC Analyst (Security Operations Center)**. His day-to-day involves alert triage, investigation, and incident response. He is busy, works with multiple tools, and his biggest fear is wasting time on false positives. He wants to scan an alert in 5 seconds, understand the context, and take immediate action. To help analysts like Daniel, **our platform leverages an AI engine** that analyzes behavioral patterns, summarizes threats, and recommends actions.

The Scenario:

Daniel is looking at his alert queue when our AI Behavioral Engine flags a high-severity alert with a Risk Score of 95/100. **The Alert:** "Suspicious Data Download". An employee (Sarah from the Finance department) downloaded an unusually high volume of sensitive files (50GB of customer data) from the company's cloud drive at 2:00 AM, using an unrecognized device.

Your Task:

We want you to design the **Entity Investigation Side-Panel** (a slide-out panel that appears over the main screen when Daniel clicks on this specific alert). **Please do not design an entire dashboard.** Focus only on this deep-dive panel that provides Daniel with everything he needs to investigate and resolve this specific incident using our AI capabilities.

When creating your design, please solve the following UX/UI challenges:

1. **Information Hierarchy & AI Summary:** How do you present the user details, the alert description, and an AI-generated summary of the incident so Daniel understands the context in 5 seconds?
2. **Explainable AI & Trust:** Analysts often distrust AI if it feels like a "black box". How do you visually show *why* the AI flagged this event as highly suspicious, so Daniel can trust the AI's conclusion and act with confidence?
3. **AI-Powered Recommendations & Actions:** The AI should suggest immediate response actions (e.g., "Suspend User Account" or "Block Device"). Design these inline actions so they are easily accessible but have proper guardrails and confirmations to prevent mistakes.
4. **Drill-down Navigation (Pivot):** Daniel needs to see a list of the exact files that were downloaded, or details about the unrecognized device. How does the user pivot to view this extra information without losing the main context of the panel?

Deliverables:

Please present your work in a presentation format. Keep in mind we want to see your process and what led you to your decisions. It's very important for us to see how you got to the different solutions you presented.

- **Process:** Show us the story behind your work and why you chose your final design (research, wireframes, brainstorming). **If you used AI tools to assist you in any part of this process, please showcase it in your presentation** (see notes below).
- **High-Fidelity UI:** The final side-panel design based on the requirements above. **We want to see at least one full flow, not just standalone UI solutions.**

Important Notes:

- **Leverage AI in your workflow:** We highly encourage you to use various AI tools (e.g., for research, ideation, copywriting, generating mock data, etc.) wherever you see fit during your design process. Please explicitly point out in your presentation which tools you used and how they helped you reach your solutions.
- **There is no right or wrong solution here.** We just want to see your thought process.
- **Please make sure the presentation can be understood even without you presenting it.** We will be reviewing it offline, and based on your presentation, we will decide whether to invite you to a live presentation interview.

I'm available for any question at 052-3722433 (Noa)
Good luck!